

An Act

ENROLLED SENATE
BILL NO. 1477

By: Seifried of the Senate

and

Caldwell (Chad) of the
House

An Act relating to students; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 5-132, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 296, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 5-132), which relates to adult high school completion; clarifying eligibility; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 628.13, which relates to concurrent enrollment; prohibiting students of certain age or older from participating; updating statutory language; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

SUBJECT: Concurrent enrollment

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 5-132, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 296, O.S.L. 2025 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 5-132), is amended to read as follows:

Section 5-132. A. Any person lawfully present in the United States and who is of legal age and a resident of this state, over the age of twenty-one (21) and under the age of thirty (30), except as provided for concurrent enrollment in Section 628.13 of this title, and who has not completed the twelfth grade in school shall be given the same educational privileges and opportunities provided by law for children over the age of five (5) and under the age of twenty-one (21), upon submitting to the board of education of the school district in which the person resides, or the board's designee, evidence satisfactory to that board showing that during the time before he or she was age twenty-one (21) he or she was

unable to attend school for a definite period or periods of time, by reason whereof it was impossible for him or her to complete the twelfth grade before reaching the age of twenty-one (21). Provided further, the pupil shall be counted in the average daily attendance of the district where he or she attends school during the period of time provided for in this section for the purpose of calculating State Aid for the district. Provided that, beginning in the 2025-2026 school year, persons applying for and approved to attend school in accordance with the provisions of this subsection shall only be eligible if such district offers a full-time virtual education program and such persons only utilize the full-time virtual education program option for the completion of their high school education.

B. Any resident of the state who is age nineteen (19) or older, who is not enrolled in any high school program, and who has not completed the twelfth grade may attend any adult high school completion program which is established by a school district and approved by the State Board of Career and Technology Education if such attendance has the approval of the district offering the program. Such attendance shall not be counted in the average daily attendance of the district unless the Legislature appropriates monies for adult high school completion programs. Such attendance shall not be counted to meet minimum numbers for accreditation of the school district involved, and such students shall not attend classes ~~which~~ that are a part of the normal class structure of the district.

C. A person subject to the provisions of subsection A or B of this section shall not be required to take the student assessments required by Section 1210.508 of this title and shall not be included in the reports required by Section 1210.545 or 24-120.1 of this title.

SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 628.13, is amended to read as follows:

Section 628.13. A. 1. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education, in cooperation with the State Board of Education, shall actively encourage the concurrent enrollment in college or university courses of eligible high school students on high school

campuses, on college and university campuses, and via online courses.

2. The State Regents and ~~State~~ Board shall establish concurrent enrollment requirements with an emphasis on determining course readiness and take all necessary actions to ensure the availability of concurrent enrollment opportunities to students in all ~~Oklahoma~~ high schools in this state.

B. The State Board of Education in cooperation with the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education shall prepare promotional materials explaining the requirements, features, and opportunities of concurrent enrollment and shall ensure that the independent school districts distribute the materials to each student prior to enrollment for each year of high school.

C. No institution of The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education shall deny enrollment in any course to any otherwise eligible high school student, or a student of who is at least thirteen (13) years of age but not twenty-one (21) years of age or older who is receiving high-school-level instruction at home, who meets the requirements of concurrent enrollment, nor shall any independent school district prohibit any student who meets the requirements of concurrent enrollment from participating if the student is at least thirteen (13) years of age but not twenty-one (21) years of age or older.

D. 1. Each high school senior who meets the eligibility requirements for concurrent enrollment shall be entitled to receive a tuition waiver equivalent to the amount of resident tuition for a maximum of eighteen (18) credit hours in ~~their~~ his or her senior year.

2. Subject to the high school senior concurrent enrollment program being fully funded, each high school junior who meets the eligibility requirements for concurrent enrollment shall be entitled to receive a tuition waiver equivalent to the amount of resident tuition for a maximum of nine (9) credit hours in ~~their~~ his or her junior year, subject to the availability of funds.

3. Tuition waivers provided pursuant to this section shall be granted without any limitation on the number of waivers granted in

any year other than the amount of funds available for the program and the number of eligible applicants.

E. When a student earns college credit through concurrent enrollment, school districts shall provide academic credit for any concurrently enrolled higher education courses that are correlated with the academic credit awarded by the institution of higher education. Academic credit shall only be transcribed as elective credit if there is no correlation between the concurrent enrollment higher education course and a course provided by the school district.

F. On or before December 1 of each year, the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education shall issue an annual report on the concurrent enrollment program implemented pursuant to this section. The annual report shall include, but not be limited to, the following information:

1. The number of students participating in concurrent enrollment;
2. The number of students participating in concurrent enrollment who received tuition waivers pursuant to subsection D of this section;
3. The high school graduation rate of students described in paragraphs 1 and 2 of this subsection; and
4. The number of students described in paragraphs 1 and 2 of this subsection who earned an associate's degree or a bachelor's degree at an institution of higher education.

The annual report shall be posted on the websites of the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and the State Department of Education.

SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the Senate the 16th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the 28th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____